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Automating the creation of listings using augmented reality computer technology

Abstract

Provided herein are various embodiments for automating the creation of listings using augmented reality. An embodiment operates by identifying a template for a for sale object (FSO), selecting a first image of the one or more common images of the template, and determining a boundary of the first image. It is determined that a listing image of the FSO, through a camera of a computing device, is smaller than the boundary prior to taking the listing image through the camera, and instructions are provided to move the FSO to more closely align to the boundary. A command is provided to the camera to take the listing image of the FSO responsive to the detecting that the listing image of the FSO more closely aligns to the boundary. A listing for the FSO is generated using the listing image.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/773,177 titled “Automating The Creation Of Listings Using Augmented Reality Computer Technology,” filed Jan. 27, 2020, which claims priority to U.S. Provisional Appl. No. 62/900,764 titled “Automating The Creation Of Listings Using Augmented Reality Computer Technology,” filed Sep. 16, 2019, both of which are herein incorporated by reference in their entireties.

BACKGROUND

Field

(1) This disclosure is generally related to using an augmented reality system for automating the creation of listings for an ecommerce site.

Background

(2) A number of ecommerce sites exist where users can sell their unwanted items, such as MERCARI, EBAY, AMAZON, POSHMARK, LETGO, CRAIGSLIST, etc. Conventionally, in order to sell on these sites, users must manually create listings for offering their items for sale. The quality of such listings can vary greatly, and may depend on a number of factors, such as the user's experience creating listings, the information the user has on the item (such as make, model, brand, size, color, features, etc.), the user's photo taking skills, whether the user is rushed when creating the listing, whether this is the first time the user has ever tried to sell an item of this type, etc. Since a well-constructed listing will increase the likelihood that the associated item will sell, it would be advantageous if computer technology could be employed to enhance and standardize the quality of listings.

SUMMARY

(3) Provided herein are system, apparatus, article of manufacture, method and/or computer program

product embodiments, and/or combinations and sub-combinations thereof, for using computer technology to automate the creation of consistent, high quality listings for selling “for sale objects” (FSO) on an ecommerce site. In an embodiment, the computer technology provides users with an augmented reality (AR) experience for creating the listings. The computer technology employs artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning computing techniques, algorithms, methods, modules, components, software and/or other technology to enhance and improve the AR experience over time.

(4) Some embodiments are configured to or operate by: identifying a category of a FSO; accessing templates for the category from a template database; navigating a user through a computer generated augmented reality (AR) environment using the templates to generate images of the FSO; analyzing one or more of the images to determine characteristics of the FSO; and generating a listing for the FSO using the images and the characteristics. In some embodiments, the templates were generated from certain past listings of the category from a historical database, and wherein the certain past listings were selected based on one or more of: price achieved, time to sell, buyer feedback, sellability score, and/or difference between initial offer price and final selling price.

(5) Some embodiments may also be configured to or operate by: tracking the listing; and using information obtained from the tracking to improve the templates for the category using AI and ML technology.

(6) Some embodiments may further be configured to or operate by: generating the templates for the category, wherein such templates are generated by: for the category, selecting successful listings from a historical database, wherein “successful” is defined using one or more of: price achieved, time to sell, buyer feedback, sellability score, and/or difference between initial offer price and final selling price; identifying common pictures in the selected listings; and generating the templates using the common pictures.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE FIGURES

(1) The accompanying drawings are incorporated herein and form a part of the specification.

(2) FIG. 1 illustrates a block diagram of a computing environment that includes an ecommerce site where users can buy and sell items and services, where such items/services are called herein “for sale objects” (FSO), according to some embodiments.

(3) FIGS. 2A-2K collectively illustrate an augmented reality experience implemented using computer technology for facilitating the creation of consistent, high quality listings for selling FSOs on an ecommerce site, according to some embodiments.

(4) FIG. 3 illustrates a flowchart to automate the creation of consistent, high quality listings for selling FSOs via an augmented reality experience, according to some embodiments.

(5) FIG. 4 illustrates a flowchart for generating and improving templates using artificial intelligence and machine learning computer technology, where the templates are used to implement the augmented reality experience described herein, according to some embodiments.

(6) FIG. 5 illustrates an example computer system useful for implementing various embodiments.

(7) In the drawings, like reference numbers generally indicate identical or similar elements.

Additionally, generally, the left-most digit(s) of a reference number identifies the drawing in which the reference number first appears.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(8) Provided herein are system, apparatus, article of manufacture, method and/or computer program product embodiments, and/or combinations and sub-combinations thereof, for using computer technology to automate the creation of consistent, high quality listings for selling “for sale objects” (FSO) on an ecommerce site. In an embodiment, the computer technology provides users with an

augmented reality (AR) experience for creating the listings. The computer technology employs artificial intelligence (AI) and machine learning computing techniques, algorithms, methods, modules, components, software and/or other technology to enhance and improve the AR experience over time.

(9) FSOs may be any item, product, object, article, thing, piece, component, sub-component, combination, merchandise, inventory, and/or service that a user wishes to sell via an ecommerce site. When selling items on the ecommerce site, the user is sometimes called a “seller.” When buying items on the ecommerce site, the user is sometimes called a “buyer.” It is noted that a given user can be, at different times, a buyer, a seller, or simultaneously a buyer and a seller.

(10) FIG. 1 illustrates a block diagram of a computing environment **102** that includes an ecommerce site **104** where sellers **122** can sell their FSOs **124**, and buyers **126** can buy the FSOs **124**, according to some embodiments. The sellers **122** and buyers **126** can access the ecommerce site **104** via the Internet **120**.

(11) The ecommerce site **104** may include a listing database **108** that stores a plurality of listings **110**. The listings **110** may be created by sellers **122** to sell their respective FSOs **124** on the ecommerce site **104**. To do so, according to some embodiments, the sellers **122** may interact with an augmented reality (AR) listing generation module **106**, which enables sellers **122** to create more consistent, higher quality listings in an automated manner, irrespective of the knowledge, skill or experience of the sellers **122**.

(12) In some embodiments, the AR listing generation module **106** may operate with templates that are stored in a template database **114**. The templates may be generated and updated by a template generation module **116**.

(13) The FSOs **124** may each be associated with a category, such as smartphone, APPLE MACBOOK, garden tool, men's belt, motorcycle, office desk, woman's purse, and comic books, to name just some examples. These categories are stored in a category database **112**.

(14) Each of the listings **110** may have a sellability score that was generated by a sellability module **119**. Sellability score is a measure of how likely a given FSO **124** will sell on the ecommerce site **104**. For example, the sellability score for a given FSO **124** may be a number between 0 and 1, with the number indicating how likely the FSO **124** will sell on the ecommerce site **104** within a given period of time.

(15) Information that the sellability module **119** may use in generating the sellability score for a given FSO **124** can include information associated with the images in the associated listing **110**, such as but not limited to the number of image(s), the quality of the image(s), etc.

(16) Other information that the sellability module **119** may use in generating the sellability score can include a price associated with the FSO **124** (that is, the price that the FSO **124** is being offered for sale). For example, the sellability module **119** may compare the price to the Manufacturer's Suggested Retail Price (MSRP) of items similar to the FSO **124** in determining sellability score.

(17) Additional information that the sellability module **119** may use in generating the sellability score can include description information in the listing **110** associated with the FSO **124**.

(18) Other information that the sellability module **119** may use in generating the sellability score can include the features associated with the FSO **124**. Example features may include, but are not limited to, category, brand, make, model, manufacturer, configuration, customization, color, serial number, condition indicators (e.g., poor, used, like new, new), geographic location, etc.

(19) The sellability module **119** may also consider other information when generating the sellability score for a FSO **124**, such as (but not limited to) information associated with the seller **122** of the FSO **124**.

(20) Embodiments for generating and using sellability scores are further described in U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/288,158 titled “Determining Sellability Score And Cancellability Score,” filed Feb. 28, 2019, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety, and any of those embodiments may be used herein for the sellability module **119**.

(21) The ecommerce site **104** may include a database of historical information **118**. The historical information **118** may store information pertaining to listings **110** that sold or did not sell, listings **110** that sold for the highest prices, listings **110** that sold in the shortest amounts of time, listings with the highest sellability scores (as determined by the sellability module **119**), the original price and the sale price, descriptions of the associated FSOs **124** (such as make, model, brand, size, color, manufacturer, damage, year, etc.), the number of views of each listing **110**, the number and amount of offers for each listing **110**, as well as any other information included in the original listings **110** or tracked and collected by the ecommerce site **104** while the listings **110** were active (that is, prior to selling or cancellation) on the ecommerce site **104**.

(22) FIGS. 2A-2K illustrate examples of an AR experience provided by the AR listing generation module **106**, to help sellers **122** create listings **110** to sell their respective FSOs **124** on the ecommerce site **104**, according to some embodiments. This AR experience is a technological approach and solution to enable sellers **122** to, in an automated manner, create more consistent, higher quality listings **110** to enhance the likelihood that their FSOs **124** will sell on the ecommerce site **104**.

(23) FIG. 2A illustrates a woman's purse **210** which, for example purposes, seller **122A** wishes to sell. Accordingly, purse **210** represents FSO **124A**. Seller **122A** wishes to create a listing **110** for the purse **210**, in order to offer the purse **210** for sale on the ecommerce site **104**. To this end, in some embodiments, the seller **122A** points the camera app of her smartphone **204** (or other computer device having picture taking functionality and the capacity to run apps, such as notebook computers, tablets, wearables, Internet of Things (IOT) devices, appliances, etc.) at the purse **210**. This is illustrated in the example of FIG. 2A, where an image **214A** of the purse **210** is displayed in the camera display **206** of the smartphone **204**.

(24) In some embodiments, the AR listing generation module **106** may analyze the image **214A** using image recognition techniques, algorithms, methods, modules, components, software and/or other technology to identify the category of the FSO **124A** (that is, the purse **210**). Example embodiments for automatically identifying the category of FSOs **124** is provided in U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/288,379 titled "Probabilistic Item Matching And Searching," filed Feb. 28, 2019, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety, and any of those embodiments may be used herein for automatically determining the category of FSOs **124**.

(25) Also or alternatively, the AR listing generation module **106** may provide a prompt in a window **208** that requests that the seller **122A** provide the category of the FSO **124A** the seller **122A** wishes to sell, or confirm the category that was suggested by the AR listing generation module **106**. The seller **122A** may provide the category by using the keyboard of the smartphone **204** or via any other means, such as via voice input that is processed by speech recognition modules in the smartphone **204** (not shown). The category is one that is stored in the category database **112**.

(26) Once the category of the FSO **124A** has been identified (which in this case may be "woman's handbag"), the AR listing generation module **106** may retrieve templates associated with the category from the template database **114**. The templates are customized for each category, and may be used to navigate the seller **122A** through an augmented reality (AR) experience to obtain high quality pictures of the FSO **124A** that have been determined via historical information in the historical database **118** to be useful for selling FSOs **124** of the given category. These pictures can then be used to automatically create a listing **110** to sell the FSO **124A** on the ecommerce site **104**.

(27) FIG. 2A illustrates a first template **216A**. As noted above, the templates **216** are customized for each category. And, as shown in the example of FIG. 2A, the first template **216A** is a two dimensional outline of the purse **210**. This illustrates that the template **216A** (as well as the other templates **216** shown in FIGS. 2B-2I) were generated so they are customized for the category of the FSO **124A**. Generation of templates **216** will be described below with reference to FIG. 4.

(28) Still referring to FIG. 2A, the AR listing generation module **106** recognizes (through image processing techniques, algorithms, methods, modules, components, software and/or other

technology) that the image **214A** is smaller than the template **216A**. Accordingly, the AR listing generation module **106** may provide instructions in the window **208** to the seller **122A** to move closer to the purse **210** (or zoom in the picture). Upon the seller **122A** taking this action, the image **214B** of the purse **210** is as shown in FIG. 2B, wherein the size of the image **214B** has been increased to more closely align with the boundary of the template **216A**.

(29) The AR listing generation module **106** may then instruct the seller **122A** (via a message in window **208**) to take the picture. Alternatively, upon detecting that the image **214B** has substantially aligned with the boundary of the template **216A**, the AR listing generation module **106** may command the camera app in the smartphone **204** to take the picture. In doing so, the AR listing generation module **106** may automatically adjust the camera settings (such as focus, shutter speed, aperture, ISO, white balance, flash, etc.) in order to take a high quality picture of the purse **210**.

(30) The AR listing generation module **106** may then continue to navigate the seller **122A** through a series of templates **216** to take additional pictures of the purse **210**. As noted above, the templates **216** are customized for each category. The templates **216** for a given category represent views of the FSO **124** that have been determined by the AR listing generation module **106** to be useful and effective for selling items of such category. In some embodiments, the AR listing generation module **106** may determine the views (that is, the templates **216**) for a given category by analyzing listings **110** of that category that have sold in the past on the ecommerce site **104**. Such “sold” listings **110** may be stored in the historical database **118**. This operation is further described below with reference to FIG. 4.

(31) FIG. 2C illustrates a second example template **216B** for the “woman's handbag” category. The second template **216B** is a two dimension side view of a woman's handbag. The AR listing generation module **106** may instruct the seller **122A** (via a message in the window **208**) to rotate and position the purse **210** until the image **214C** in the camera display **206** fits in the second template **216B**.

(32) Upon the seller **122A** taking this action, the image **214D** of the purse **210** is as shown in FIG. 2D, wherein the purse **210** has been rotated and positioned so that the image **214D** aligns with the second template **216B**. The AR listing generation module **106** may then instruct the seller **122A** (via a message in window **208**) to take the picture. Alternatively, upon detecting that the image **214D** has approached the boundary of the template **216B**, the AR listing generation module **106** may command the camera app in the smartphone **204** to take the picture, as described above.

(33) FIG. 2E illustrates a third example template **216C** for the “woman's handbag” category. The purpose of the third template **216C** may be to take a picture of the label **217** of the purse **210**. Accordingly, the AR listing generation module **106** may instruct the seller **122A** (via a message in the window **208**) to open the purse **210** and position the smartphone **204** above the purse **210** so that the label **217** is within the third template **216C** on the camera display **206**.

(34) Upon the seller **122A** taking this action, the image **214E** of the purse **210** is as shown in FIG. 2F, wherein the label **217** of the purse **210** is within, and aligns with the third template **216C**. The AR listing generation module **106** may then instruct the seller **122A** (via a message in window **208**) to take the picture. Alternatively, upon detecting the label **217** within the template **216C**, the AR listing generation module **106** may command the camera app in the smartphone **204** to take the picture, as described above.

(35) In some embodiments, the AR listing generation module **106** may use well known image processing and optical character recognition (OCR) techniques, algorithms, methods, modules, components, software and/or other technology to detect and recognize the information on the label **217**. Such information may include the manufacturer, model, brand, designer, size, year and location of production, color, and/or other information pertaining to the FSO **124A** (that is, the purse **210**). The AR listing generation module **106** may include some or all of this information in the listing **110** for the FSO **124A**.

(36) FIG. 2G illustrates a fourth example template **216D** for the “woman's handbag” category. The fourth template **216D** is a three dimension view of a woman's handbag. The AR listing generation module **106** may instruct the seller **122A** (via a message in the window **208**) to position either the smartphone **204** and/or the purse **210** until the image **214F** in the camera display **206** aligns with the fourth template **216D**.

(37) Upon the seller **122A** taking this action, the image **214F** of the purse **210** is as shown in FIG. 2H, wherein the smartphone **204** and/or purse **210** has been positioned so that the image **214F** aligns with the fourth template **216D** in the camera display **206**. As shown in FIG. 2H, however, the camera display **206** also includes an image **222** of a flower in a vase **220**. This flower image **222** represents items in the background (sometimes called herein “background noise”) that may detract from the listing **110** being created.

(38) In some embodiments, the AR listing generation module **106** may detect the presence of background noise by using well known image processing techniques, algorithms, methods, modules, components, software and/or other technology to detect if any high frequency image elements exist outside the current template (that is, outside the fourth template **216D**). If any do exist, then the AR listing generation module **106** may conclude that the camera display **206** contains background noise. In this case, the AR listing generation module **106** may instruct the seller **122A** (via a message in window **208**) to remove any objects in the camera display **206** other than the FSO **124A**. Additionally or alternatively, the AR listing generation module **106** may process the image in the camera display **206** to automatically remove background noise. This may be done using any appropriate image and/or filtering processing techniques, algorithms, methods, modules, components, software and/or other technology, such as through use of bilateral filter(s).

(39) After background noise has been removed, the image **214F** of the purse **210** is as shown in FIG. 2I. The AR listing generation module **106** may then instruct the seller **122A** (via a message in window **208**) to take the picture. Alternatively, the AR listing generation module **106** may command the camera app in the smartphone **204** to take the picture, as described above.

(40) In some embodiments, the AR listing generation module **106** may use well known image processing techniques, algorithms, methods, modules, components, software and/or other technology to analyze the image **214F** to determine the dimensions of the purse **210**. An example of such well known technology is the APPLE MEASURE app. An example of such processing is shown in FIG. 2J, where the image **214F** of the purse **210** has been annotated with dimensional information. The AR listing generation module **106** may include this annotated image **214F** in the listing **110** for the purse **210**.

(41) Also or alternatively, the AR listing generation module **106** may create a new image **250** (see FIG. 2K) of a woman **224** holding the purse **210** (shown as **226**). In this new image **250**, the annotated image **214F** from FIG. 2J has been scaled based on the dimensions of the purse **210** and an average sized woman **224**. The AR listing generation module **106** may include this new image **250** in the listing **110**.

(42) Accordingly, by navigating the seller **122A** through the templates **216** associated with the category of the FSO **124**, the AR listing generation module **106** is able to obtain pictures and information pertaining to the FSO **124** for inclusion in the listing **110**. As noted above, the templates **216** are customized for the category, and were determined by the AR listing generation module **106** to be useful and effective for selling items of such category. Accordingly, through use of innovative technology, this disclosure describes embodiments that are able to automatically generate listings **110** that are of consistent high quality irrespective of the seller **122**'s skill, knowledge and/or experience creating listings and/or other factors (described herein) that typically cause listings to be of inconsistent and/or low quality. As a result, sellers' are assured that their FSOs **124** have a greater likelihood of selling on the ecommerce site **104**. Also, as will be appreciated by persons skilled in the relevant arts, because the templates **216** operate to superimpose computer-generated images on users' view of the real world, the AR listing generation

module **106** uses computing technology to effectively generate an augmented reality environment for enabling the foregoing.

(43) FIG. 3 illustrates a flowchart for a method **302** to automate the creation of consistent, high quality listings **110** for selling FSOs **124** via an augmented reality experience, according to some embodiments. Method **302** can be performed by processing logic that can comprise hardware (e.g., circuitry, dedicated logic, programmable logic, microcode, etc.), software (e.g., instructions executing on a processing device), or a combination thereof. It is to be appreciated that not all steps may be needed to perform the disclosure provided herein. Further, some of the steps may be performed simultaneously, or in a different order than shown in FIG. 3, as will be understood by a person of ordinary skill in the art.

(44) Method **302** shall be described with reference to FIGS. 1 and 2A-2K. However, method **302** is not limited to those example embodiments.

(45) In **304**, the AR listing generation module **106** may identify the category of the FSO **124A** that the seller **122A** wishes to sell. In some embodiments, this may be achieved by the seller **122A** taking a picture of the FSO **124A**. Then, the AR listing generation module **106** may analyze the image **214A** using image recognition techniques, algorithms, methods, modules, components, software and/or other technology to identify the category of the FSO **124A**, as described above. For purposes of example, assume that the purse **210** in FIG. 2A is the FSO **124A**.

(46) In **306**, the AR listing generation module **106** may access templates from the template database **114** associated with the identified category. As described above, the templates are customized for the identified category.

(47) In **308**, the AR listing generation module **106** may navigate the seller **122A** through the templates to obtain high quality pictures of the FSO **124A**. Examples of this are described above with respect to FIGS. 2A-2K.

(48) In **310**, the AR listing generation module **106** may analyze some or all of the pictures to obtain and determine characteristics of the FSO **124A**, such as make, model, brand, size, color, manufacturer, damage, year, etc. For example, the AR listing generation module **106** may analyze the tag **217** of the purse **210**, as described above with respect to FIGS. 2E and 2F. Also or alternatively, as indicated by **312**, the AR listing generation module **106** may determine the dimensions of the FSO **124A** and generate one or more images using the dimensional information (as described above with respect to FIGS. 2J and 2K).

(49) In **314**, the AR listing generation module **106** may automatically generate a listing **110** for the FSO **124A** using the images and pictures generated in **308** and **312**, and the information pertaining to the FSO **124A** that was obtained in **310**.

(50) In some embodiments, the AR listing generation module **106** may also generate a suggested offer price for the FSO **124A**, based on historical information of past listings of the same or similar FSOs **124**, contained in the historical database **118**. For example, the AR listing generation module **106** may use the average selling price of certain past listings as the suggested offer price, where the certain past listings are selected based on any combination of: highest selling price, shortest time to sell, number of offers, difference between initial offer price and final selling price, etc.

Embodiments for generating suggested offer prices for FSOs **124** are described in U.S. Patent Application titled "Inventory Ingestion And Pricing System," Ser. No. 16/288,203, filed Feb. 28, 2019, which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety, and any of those embodiments may be used herein.

(51) In **316**, the AR listing generation module **106** may display the listing **110** to the seller **122A** for review and editing.

(52) In **318**, after the seller **122A** has edited and approved the listing **110**, the listing **110** may be added to the listing database **108**, and may be published on the ecommerce site **104**. At that point, the listing **110** is active and may be browsed and purchased by buyers **126**.

(53) In **320**, the AR listing generation module **106** may track the listing **110** while it is active on the

ecommerce site **104**. Using information gathered while tracking the listing **110**, the AR listing generation module **106** (working with the template generation module **116**) may use AI and ML computing techniques, algorithms, methods, modules, components, software and/or other technology to improve the templates **216** of the category associated with the FSO **124A**. Such operation may be similar to—at least in part—the process for generating templates for a given category, which shall now be described with respect to FIG. 4.

(54) In **404**, for a given category, the template generation module **116** may select certain listings **110** from the historical database **118**. These certain listings **110** are for FSOs **124** that were sold. Also, these certain listings **110** are ones that were “successful,” where success may be defined by any number of metrics, such as highest price achieved, shortest time to sell, high feedback from buyer, highest sellability score, small difference between initial offer price and final selling price, etc., or any combination thereof.

(55) In **406**, the template generation module **116** may analyze the pictures in these selected listings **110** to generate templates **216** for the category. For example, as indicated by **408**, the template generation module **116** may identify pictures that are common to the selected listings **110**, and then generate templates **216** (such as outlines of the FSOs **124** in the pictures) based on those common pictures. Examples of templates **216** for the category “woman's handbag” are shown in FIGS. 2A-2k.

(56) As indicated in **408**, in the course of tracking listings **110** (as described above in **320**), the template generation module **116** may analyze the pictures in new “successful” listings **110** for a given category (where success is defined as described above) to amend or augment the templates **216** for the category.

Example Computer System

(57) Various embodiments and/or components therein can be implemented, for example, using one or more computer systems, such as computer system **500** shown in FIG. 5. Computer system **500** can be any computer or computing device capable of performing the functions described herein. For example, one or more computer systems **500** or portions thereof can be used to implement any embodiments described herein, and/or any combination or sub-combination thereof.

(58) Computer system **500** includes one or more processors (also called central processing units, or CPUs), such as a processor **504**. Processor **504** is connected to a communication infrastructure or bus **506**.

(59) One or more processors **504** can each be a graphics processing unit (GPU). In some embodiments, a GPU is a processor that is a specialized electronic circuit designed to process mathematically intensive applications. The GPU can have a parallel structure that is efficient for parallel processing of large blocks of data, such as mathematically intensive data common to computer graphics applications, images, videos, etc.

(60) Computer system **500** also includes user input/output device(s) **503**, such as monitors, keyboards, pointing devices, etc., that communicate with communication infrastructure **506** through user input/output interface(s) **502**.

(61) Computer system **500** also includes a main or primary memory **508**, such as random access memory (RAM). Main memory **508** can include one or more levels of cache. Main memory **508** has stored therein control logic (i.e., computer software) and/or data.

(62) Computer system **500** can also include one or more secondary storage devices or memory **510**. Secondary memory **510** can include, for example, a hard disk drive **512** and/or a removable storage device or drive **514**. Removable storage drive **514** can be a floppy disk drive, a magnetic tape drive, a compact disk drive, an optical storage device, tape backup device, and/or any other storage device/drive.

(63) Removable storage drive **514** can interact with a removable storage unit **518**. Removable storage unit **518** includes a computer usable or readable storage device having stored thereon computer software (control logic) and/or data. Removable storage unit **518** can be a floppy disk,

magnetic tape, compact disk, DVD, optical storage disk, and/or any other computer data storage device. Removable storage drive **514** reads from and/or writes to removable storage unit **518** in a well-known manner.

(64) According to an exemplary embodiment, secondary memory **510** can include other means, instrumentalities or other approaches for allowing computer programs and/or other instructions and/or data to be accessed by computer system **500**. Such means, instrumentalities or other approaches can include, for example, a removable storage unit **522** and an interface **520**. Examples of the removable storage unit **522** and the interface **520** can include a program cartridge and cartridge interface (such as that found in video game devices), a removable memory chip (such as an EPROM or PROM) and associated socket, a memory stick and USB port, a memory card and associated memory card slot, and/or any other removable storage unit and associated interface.

(65) Computer system **500** can further include a communication or network interface **524**. Communication interface **524** enables computer system **500** to communicate and interact with any combination of remote devices, remote networks, remote entities, etc. (individually and collectively referenced by reference number **528**). For example, communication interface **524** can allow computer system **500** to communicate with remote devices **528** over communications path **526**, which can be wired and/or wireless, and which can include any combination of LANs, WANs, the Internet, etc. Control logic and/or data can be transmitted to and from computer system **500** via communication path **526**.

(66) In some embodiments, a non-transitory, tangible apparatus or article of manufacture comprising a tangible computer useable or readable medium having control logic (software) stored thereon is also referred to herein as a computer program product or program storage device. This includes, but is not limited to, computer system **500**, main memory **508**, secondary memory **510**, and removable storage units **518** and **522**, as well as tangible articles of manufacture embodying any combination of the foregoing. Such control logic, when executed by one or more data processing devices (such as computer system **500**), causes such data processing devices to operate as described herein.

(67) Based on the teachings contained in this disclosure, it will be apparent to persons skilled in the relevant art(s) how to make and use embodiments of this disclosure using data processing devices, computer systems and/or computer architectures other than that shown in FIG. 5. In particular, embodiments can operate with software, hardware, and/or operating system implementations other than those described herein.

CONCLUSION

(68) It is to be appreciated that the Detailed Description section, and not the Summary and Abstract sections, is intended to be used to interpret the claims. The Summary and Abstract sections can set forth one or more but not all exemplary embodiments as contemplated by the inventors, and thus, are not intended to limit this disclosure or the appended claims in any way.

(69) While this disclosure describes exemplary embodiments for exemplary fields and applications, it should be understood that the disclosure is not limited thereto. Other embodiments and modifications thereto are possible, and are within the scope and spirit of this disclosure. For example, and without limiting the generality of this paragraph, embodiments are not limited to the software, hardware, firmware, and/or entities illustrated in the figures and/or described herein. Further, embodiments (whether or not explicitly described herein) have significant utility to fields and applications beyond the examples described herein.

(70) Embodiments have been described herein with the aid of functional building blocks illustrating the implementation of specified functions and relationships thereof. The boundaries of these functional building blocks have been arbitrarily defined herein for the convenience of the description. Alternate boundaries can be defined as long as the specified functions and relationships (or equivalents thereof) are appropriately performed. Also, alternative embodiments can perform functional blocks, steps, operations, methods, etc. using orderings different than those described

herein.

(71) References herein to “one embodiment,” “an embodiment,” “an example embodiment,” or similar phrases, indicate that the embodiment described can include a particular feature, structure, or characteristic, but every embodiment can not necessarily include the particular feature, structure, or characteristic. Moreover, such phrases are not necessarily referring to the same embodiment. Further, when a particular feature, structure, or characteristic is described in connection with an embodiment, it would be within the knowledge of persons skilled in the relevant art(s) to incorporate such feature, structure, or characteristic into other embodiments whether or not explicitly mentioned or described herein. Additionally, some embodiments can be described using the expression “coupled” and “connected” along with their derivatives. These terms are not necessarily intended as synonyms for each other. For example, some embodiments can be described using the terms “connected” and/or “coupled” to indicate that two or more elements are in direct physical or electrical contact with each other. The term “coupled,” however, can also mean that two or more elements are not in direct contact with each other, but yet still co-operate or interact with each other.

(72) The breadth and scope of this disclosure should not be limited by any of the above-described exemplary embodiments, but should be defined only in accordance with the following claims and their equivalents.

Claims

1. A computer implemented method, comprising: identifying a template for a for sale object (FSO), the template comprising one or more common images selected from one or more listings of one or more previously sold objects that are similar to the FSO; selecting a first image of the one or more common images of the template; determining a boundary of the first image; determining, by one or more processors, that a listing image of the FSO, through a camera of a computing device, is smaller than the boundary prior to taking the listing image through the camera; providing instructions, by the one or more processors, via the computing device to move the FSO to more closely align to the boundary; detecting, by the one or more processors, that the listing image of the FSO more closely aligns to the boundary; providing, by the one or more processors, a command to the camera to take the listing image of the FSO responsive to the detecting that the listing image of the FSO more closely aligns to the boundary; and generating, by the one or more processors, a listing for the FSO using the listing image.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the template was generated from certain past listings of a category from a historical database, and wherein the certain past listings were selected based on one or more of: price achieved, time to sell, buyer feedback, sellability score, and/or difference between initial offer price and final selling price.
3. The method of claim 1, further comprising: tracking the listing; and using information obtained from the tracking to improve the template for a category using AI and ML technology.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the template comprises a two-dimensional outline of a shape corresponding to the FSO.
5. The method of claim 4, further comprising: providing, after providing the command, a second template, comprising a two-dimensional outline of a second shape corresponding to the FSO for a second listing image, wherein the listing includes both the listing image and the second listing image.
6. The method of claim 4, wherein the two-dimensional outline is displayed on a screen corresponding to the camera.
7. The method of claim 1, wherein the instructions are provided to a user.
8. The method of claim 1, wherein the camera corresponds to an app on a mobile device.
9. The method of claim 1, further comprising: adjusting, by the one or more processors, a focus or

shutter speed of the camera.

10. A system comprising at least one processor, the at least one processor configured to perform operations comprising: identifying a template for a for sale object (FSO), the template comprising one or more common images selected from one or more listings of one or more previously sold objects that are similar to the FSO; selecting a first image of the one or more common images of the template; determining a boundary of the first image; determining, by the one or more processors, that a listing image of the FSO, through a camera of a computing device, is smaller than the boundary prior to taking the listing image through the camera; providing instructions, by the one or more processors, via the computing device to move the FSO to more closely align to the boundary; detecting, by the one or more processors, that the listing image of the FSO more closely aligns to the boundary; providing, by the one or more processors, a command to the camera to take the listing image of the FSO responsive to the detecting that the listing image of the FSO more closely aligns to the boundary; and generating, by the one or more processors, a listing for the FSO using the listing image.

11. The system of claim 10, wherein the template was generated from certain past listings of a category from a historical database, and wherein the certain past listings were selected based on one or more of: price achieved, time to sell, buyer feedback, sellability score, and/or difference between initial offer price and final selling price.

12. The system of claim 10, the operations further comprising: tracking the listing; and using information obtained from the tracking to improve the template for a category using AI and ML technology.

13. The system of claim 10, wherein the template comprises a two-dimensional outline of a shape corresponding to the FSO.

14. The system of claim 13, the operations further comprising: providing, after providing the command, a second template, comprising a two-dimensional outline of a second shape corresponding to the FSO for a second listing image, wherein the listing includes both the listing image and the second listing image.

15. The system of claim 13, wherein the two-dimensional outline is displayed on a screen corresponding to the camera.

16. The system of claim 10, wherein the instructions are provided to a user.

17. The system of claim 10, wherein the camera corresponds to an app on a mobile device.

18. The system of claim 10, the operations further comprising: adjusting, by the one or more processors, a focus or shutter speed of the camera.

19. A non-transitory computer-readable medium having instructions stored thereon that, when executed by at least one computing device, cause the at least one computing device to perform operations comprising: identifying a template for a for sale object (FSO), the template comprising one or more common images selected from one or more listings of one or more previously sold objects that are similar to the FSO; selecting a first image of the one or more common images of the template; determining a boundary of the first image; determining, by the at least one computing device, that a listing image of the FSO, through a camera of a computing device, is smaller than the boundary prior to taking the listing image through the camera; providing instructions, by the at least one computing device, via the computing device to move the FSO to more closely align to the boundary; detecting, by the at least one computing device, that the listing image of the FSO more closely aligns to the boundary; providing, by the at least one computing device, a command to the camera to take the listing image of the FSO responsive to the detecting that the listing image of the FSO more closely aligns to the boundary; and generating, by the at least one computing device, a listing for the FSO using the listing image.

20. The non-transitory computer-readable medium of claim 19, wherein the template comprises a two-dimensional outline of a shape corresponding to the FSO.
